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PIL PENDING FOR 14 YEARS

IS CHEMBUR WAITING FOR A DISASTER?

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It took just one leaking tanker to expose a problem Chembur residents have been warning about for years — what happens when an industrial emergency meets an already-constricted road network?

On Monday night, a tanker carrying nearly 28 tonnes of highly flammable benzene developed a leak near the Mysore Colony Monorail station on Mahul Road. Within minutes, the situation turned into a full-scale emergency operation. A 500-metre safety cordon was established, traffic on Mahul Road and Mysore Colony Road was stopped, and Monorail services at Mysore Colony were halted.

The BMC Disaster Management Cell received the incident report at around 8.12 p.m. Fire Brigade teams rushed to the spot as the possibility of fire or a dangerous vapour cloud posed a serious threat in the densely populated industrial-residential belt.

Fire personnel used water fogging around the tanker to suppress vapours and reduce the risk of ignition. A HAZMAT vehicle was brought in, and the leaking benzene was carefully transferred into another tanker.

The decanting operation was completed at around 10.20 p.m. The tankers were subsequently moved towards the BPCL refinery premises, and the affected road was washed with jet water as a precaution.

No one was injured. But for more than two hours, a key road corridor was effectively taken out of service. And that is where an old legal battle over Chembur's roads acquires a new and disturbing relevance. The area is home to several sensitive installations, including HPCL and BPCL oil refineries, Tata thermal power plant and BARC.

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Masjid Near T2

Somaiya calls for action

BJP leader inspected spot of 'illegal' structure near Airport terminal

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A religious structure identified as a mosque, allegedly constructed illegally on airport land near CSMIA's Terminal 2, has triggered questions over land encroachment, airport security and the role of authorities. This followed BJP leader Kirit Somaiya's visit to the spot on September 2.

According to claims made during the inspection, the structure has stood at the location for around 10 years, raising questions about how an alleged unauthorised construction could remain in place for so long near one of Mumbai's most sensitive aviation facilities. Officials from Adani Airports, the BMC and the Mumbai Metropolitan Region Development Authority (MMRDA) were present during the inspection.

Somaiya alleged that an empty plot opposite the airport was gradually converted into a mosque despite the land allegedly belonging to the airport. He questioned how construction could take place at the location and continue for years without intervention from the concerned authorities. He also raised questions about the presence of electricity, water, air-conditioning equipment and other electrical installations on the premises, seeking to know who permitted or facilitated these facilities.


Kirit Somaiya

The BJP leader later visited Sahar Police Station and discussed the matter with senior police officials. He demanded an inquiry into the alleged unauthorised construction and sought immediate action against the structure. He also demanded that the airport land be taken back into possession, the alleged illegal structure be removed, and the premises be sealed.

The most significant question now is not merely when the structure was built, but how it allegedly remained there for nearly a decade. If official records establish that the plot belongs to the airport and that the construction had no valid permission, authorities will have to determine when the first construction activity took place, who carried it out.

The issue also assumes importance because construction and development around Mumbai airport are subject to specific planning and aviation-related restrictions. MMRDA is the Special Planning Authority for the Mumbai International Airport Notified Area, while other agencies have responsibilities concerning civic infrastructure and enforcement.

The authorities are now expected to verify the ownership of the exact land parcel, examine municipal and planning records, establish the age of the structure and check whether any permission, lease, allotment or other legal document exists in connection with the premises. The source and legality of the electricity and water connections will also need to be examined.

Police action will depend on the findings of this verification. If the structure is formally established to be an unauthorised construction or an encroachment, the concerned civic or planning authority can initiate proceedings under the applicable laws.

The inquiry will also have to answer a larger administrative question: if the structure had indeed existed for nearly 10 years in the immediate vicinity of an international airport, what were the concerned authorities doing during that period?

Were routine inspections carried out? Did airport security personnel report the structure? Did BMC or MMRDA receive complaints? Were utility connections scrutinised? Did any department issue notices? If notices were issued, why did the structure continue to stand?

For now, the authorities' verification and subsequent action will determine the structure's legal status.



FROM THE EDITOR'S DESK

Pune Times Mirror, Mumbai
S Balakrishnan

CM Yogi ought to act on IAS officer's case

Uttar Pradesh chief minister Yogi Adityanath is doing commendable work. He has put the fear of law in the hearts of criminals and improved the law-and-order situation in the state in a remarkable manner. The whole of UP is talking about this. In terms of infrastructure development and attracting investments too, he has performed very well. He also handled the "chanda chori" controversy at the Ayodhya Ram Temple with a lot of maturity. More importantly, there is not even a whiff of corruption against his administration. His track record is so enviable that there is a buzz in the corridors of power in Lutyens' Delhi that he could succeed Modi to the prime ministerial chair.

However, it's a big mystery why he has allowed his excellent track record to be spoiled in one fell swoop by one of his party MLAs? Divya Mittal, an IAS officer of 13 years' experience, who had graduated from IIT and IIM before clearing the UPSC exam, got a drinking water connection to a remote village in Mirzapur district which had remained dry for over 75 years. The local legislator was upset that he was not invited for the "jal pujan" or inauguration of the tap and got her transferred. This is shockingly outrageous. Yogi should intervene immediately and persuade Mittal to rescind her decision to quit. In another case, the BJP government in Madhya Pradesh is refusing to give sanction for the prosecution of one of its ministers, Vijay Shah, who made an anti-national remark against Col Sofiya Quereshi of Operation Sindoor fame. He called her "sister of terrorists" just because she is a Muslim. This man has insulted the entire armed forces. Ideally, he should have been summarily sacked and prosecuted. But the BJP government is not even granting permission to prosecute him. His apology adds up to zilch.

Kharghar locals up in arms

Visit CIDCO office with water shortage complaint

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Representatives from 35 housing societies in Kharghar (Sectors 4 and 35) lodged a formal complaint at the local CIDCO office regarding severe water shortage. It was revealed that residents were spending lakhs of rupees on water tankers. According to the residents, Vishwahans Society was spending Rs. 1 lakh monthly, while Anaya Society was spending Rs. 4 lakh for the same period.

Led by Ishika Deepak Sudhija and Shiv Sena MLA Haresh Keni, the residents met officials Chetan Devde and Rahul Sarode. Addressing the gathering, the officials stated that the pipeline bringing 69 MLD of water from JNT is expected to be completed by March 2025, and an additional 10 MLD of water would be sourced from Mumbai starting September 4.

However, the residents expressed deep frustration. They had purchased their "dream homes" expecting CIDCO to provide all basic amenities, yet even after ten years, their difficulties persist. Many officials have changed, but the problems remain unresolved. Residents expressed that their patience has run out; they stated that if no action is taken now, their next form of protest would be to demand that CIDCO take back their homes — a highly emotional sentiment shared by those present.

Local MLA Keni He urged for a resolution to the crisis, warning that if the issue wasn't settled, a massive public agitation would be inevitable.


Kharghar residents meet CIDCO officials

From waste to wow

Eco-friendly Ganpati décor ideas for Mumbai homes

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As Ganeshotsav brings colour, music and elaborate decorations to Mumbai homes, housing societies and pandals, an increasing number of devotees are looking beyond conventional plastic and thermocol décor. In a city where thousands of idols and temporary decorations become part of the festival every year, choosing materials that can be reused, recycled or naturally decomposed can make celebrations considerably lighter on the environment.

For Mumbai homes, where space is often limited, an eco-friendly decoration can also be a practical choice. A compact Ganpati corner does not need an elaborate mandap. A fabric backdrop, a few flower garlands and traditional diyas can create a festive setting without filling the house with disposable material.

Turn the household into a décor store

Before heading to Crawford Market, Dadar or a neighbourhood decoration shop, look around the house. An old saree can become a colourful backdrop, while unused dupattas can be draped around the idol. Wooden trays, cane baskets and brass utensils can be incorporated into the setup instead of buying new decorative pieces.

Cardboard boxes and paper bags can also be transformed into festive motifs. Paper flowers, traditional torans and cut-outs can be made at home, giving children an opportunity to participate in the preparations.

Flowers over plastic

Mumbai's flower markets see a surge in demand during Ganeshotsav. Marigolds, roses and other seasonal flowers can be used to frame the idol or create simple garlands. Once the celebrations are over, flowers can be separated from other waste and composted or disposed of through appropriate organic-waste channels.

Leaves such as mango and banana can also lend a traditional touch to the décor. Unlike synthetic garlands and plastic embellishments, natural decorations do not leave behind the same kind of persistent waste.

Give waste a second life

With households already dealing with packaging waste, festival preparations offer an opportunity to repurpose materials that might otherwise be thrown away. Newspaper can be rolled into decorative flowers, old cardboard can become the base of a backdrop, and glass jars can be converted into holders for flowers or lights.

The key is to avoid materials that are difficult to recycle, particularly thermocol, plastic-coated decorations and glitter that can shed tiny particles into the environment.

Closure notice on mall

SC ordered fire-damaged building not to be used until repaired completely

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The Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) ordered the immediate closure and evacuation of Orchid City Centre Mall on Bellasis Road, Mumbai Central, following a Supreme Court directive that bars the use or occupation of the fire-damaged building until it is fully repaired and cleared for safe use. The BMC's D Ward issued a formal notice on September 1, directing shop owners, occupants and visitors to vacate the premises and prohibiting anyone from entering or using the building.

The action follows the Supreme Court's August 25 order in Esa Usman Seliya & Ors vs The Municipal Corporation of Greater Mumbai & Ors, in which a bench of Justices Ahsanuddin Amanullah and Manmohan directed the civic authority to ensure that the entire building remains unused until the builder completes repairs in all respects. The court further clarified that the building cannot be used for any purpose unless the BMC is satisfied that every floor is structurally safe and meets the applicable statutory requirements.

The Supreme Court also directed that the building, as a whole, must remain non-functional and nobody should be permitted to enter the premises during this period. Re-entry and re-occupation will be allowed only after the construction and repair work is completed and the competent municipal authority issues the required clearance certificates afresh. The court directed that these measures should preferably be implemented within two months of its order.

Following the order, officials from the BMC's Building Proposal department, Mumbai Fire Brigade and D Ward issued an eviction intimation to the developers, including M/s Neelkamal Realtors & Builders Pvt. Ltd., M/s DB Realty and M/s Neelkamal City Shopping Mall India Ltd. The notice also covers occupants of shops and units on the ground and first floors, asking them to immediately vacate their galas, shops and premises.

The civic body warned that failure to comply could lead to forcible eviction, with the costs and consequences borne by the owners and occupants. It also stated that unauthorised entry or continued occupation would amount to contempt of the Supreme Court's order.

The latest action stems from the mall's major fire of October 22, 2020. The blaze triggered a 56-hour firefighting operation before the last embers were extinguished. The incident also brought scrutiny on the large number of unauthorised commercial units operating inside the complex. In the aftermath, the BMC demolished more than 700 unauthorised shops and units on the premises.

The Supreme Court's latest directions therefore keep Orchid City Centre effectively shut until the outstanding structural repairs, statutory fire-safety requirements and fresh permissions are completed. For occupants, reopening is no longer a matter of simply resuming business. The entire building must first satisfy the safety conditions laid down by the court and the civic authorities.



Orchid City Centre Mall in Mumbai Central

Ideal Teacher Mayor Awards

BMC names winners



Mayor Ritu Tawde and BMC officials announce the winners

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With Teachers' Day approaching, the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) has announced the names of recipients of the 'Adarsh Shikshak Mayor Award' for 2025-26 on Thursday. Mumbai Mayor Ritu Tawde and Education Committee Chairperson Rajeshree Shirwadkar addressed the media.

The award-winning teachers are Nilima Nishikant Kadam, Nirmala Ajay Kurhe, Jayashree Bhagwan Kamble, Vidya Jitendra Patil, Vrushali Vishwanath Gosavi, Veena Sandeep Jathar, Vasant Govind Shinde, Rashmi Ajit Patil, Rasika Rajesh Gosavi, and Kalpana Chandrakant Bambale.

The award is an annual initiative of the BMC's education department to recognise teachers for their contribution to students and the education system. The civic body has traditionally honoured teachers and headmasters from different categories of schools, including BMC-run primary and secondary schools, special schools and private aided schools.

The award programme is held in connection with Teachers' Day, observed on September 5 to mark the birth anniversary of former President and educationist Dr Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan. According to information published by the BMC, 50 headmasters and teachers have traditionally been selected for the Mayor's Ideal Teacher Award.

The selection process involves multiple stages. As per the civic body's prescribed procedure, teachers considered exemplary in their respective areas are first recommended at the departmental level. These recommendations are scrutinised by education officials before eligible candidates are considered for further evaluation. A municipal-level committee then selects the final 50 awardees.

The recognition is intended to encourage teachers to continue their work and acknowledge their contribution towards shaping students beyond academic learning. For municipal schools, where teachers work with students from varied social and economic backgrounds, such recognition also brings attention to their work within the civic education system.

In previous editions, the award has included a cash prize along with a medal, shawl, memento and certificate. In 2021-22, for instance, 50 teachers were selected after interviews involving 103 candidates, with each awardee receiving a cash prize of Rs. 10,000 and other honours.

Woman fights off assault on train

Emergency call raises railway safety questions

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A 20-year-old college student travelling alone in a ladies' coach on an early-morning Dahanu-Borivali MEMU allegedly found herself fighting for her safety after an unidentified man entered the compartment and attempted to assault her near Vangaon on Thursday.

The incident has not only highlighted the vulnerability of women travelling alone in relatively empty compartments during the early hours but has also raised questions about the emergency response available to passengers in distress.

According to reports, the student boarded the 5.17 a.m. MEMU service from Dahanu. While she was travelling alone in the ladies' compartment, an unidentified man, believed to be in his late twenties, allegedly entered the coach. After initially asking her about the train's location, he allegedly attacked her and attempted to overpower her.

Fighting back

The student fought back instead of remaining passive. She reportedly put her fingers into the attacker's eyes, pushed him away and raised an alarm. Her cries alerted people in nearby coaches, following which passengers attempted to intervene. The accused, however, managed to flee near Vangaon.

What adds another layer to the incident is the student's reported attempt to seek emergency assistance. According to reports, she tried contacting 112, the national emergency number, but allegedly did not receive an immediate response.

The allegation warrants clarification from the authorities, particularly because railway passengers have dedicated channels for seeking assistance. Mumbai Railway Police officially lists 1512 as its emergency helpline for safety and crime-related assistance, along with control-room numbers. Western Railway also operates the integrated 139 helpline, which includes a security and medical assistance option.

Questions raised

The incident, therefore, raises a basic but critical question: when a woman is facing an immediate threat inside a moving train, how quickly can help reach her?

The concern becomes more significant during the early morning hours, when coaches can have very few passengers. Railway Police itself advises women travelling at night to use compartments where a sizeable number of commuters are present.

While the student's presence of mind helped prevent the alleged assault from escalating, the incident has once again brought attention to the security arrangements in women's coaches, particularly on early-morning and late-night services.

It also raises questions about whether passengers clearly know which emergency number to use and whether calls made during an ongoing incident are being routed to personnel capable of reaching the train quickly.

The student's courage may have helped her escape a potentially serious assault. But for railway authorities, the incident presents a different challenge, ensuring that women do not have to rely solely on their own courage when an emergency occurs inside a train.



Mumbai Mayor Ritu Tawde (right) and Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation Education Committee Chairperson Rajashree Shirwadkar feed jalebis to each other after a meeting at the BMC headquarters on Thursday. The two had a public tiff over certain issues recently. With the offering of the sweet, they seem to have put their differences aside and buried all bitterness.

Here's BJP's new go-to gentleman

Prasad Lad's backchannel role proved well in cooling down Manoj Jarange Patil

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Manoj Jarange Patil's Maratha reservation agitation at Antarwali Sarati in Jalna district has triggered a quiet but significant shake-up within state politics. For years, whenever the BJP or the state government faced a political flashpoint, Minister Girish Mahajan was the go-to man, the party's trusted troubleshooter. But the way MLC Prasad Lad has handled the delicate negotiations at Antarwali Sarati has political circles buzzing with one question: has the BJP found itself a new troubleshooter?

A direct invite from Jarange Patil himself

Communication between Jarange Patil and the state government had hit repeated roadblocks over the Maratha quota issue. It was against this backdrop that Jarange personally invited BJP MLC Prasad Lad to Antarwali Sarati for talks, a move that signalled where the real channel of communication within the Mahayuti government, and particularly within the BJP, was now shifting.


Prasad Lad

Fadnavis's trusted man for a sensitive job

Lad is widely regarded as one of CM Devendra Fadnavis's closest aides. Given the political tension between Jarange and Fadnavis, carrying the government's message and Fadnavis's own position across to Jarange was an extremely sensitive task. Lad reportedly pulled off this soft diplomacy with skill, building a bridge of trust between both camps.

Administrative talks meet personal touch

When the high-level government delegation led by Radhakrishna Vikhe Patil travelled to Antarwali, Lad was there as the key mediator. But he didn't stop at legal and administrative points alone, he also visited Jarange in hospital and engaged with him on a personal, empathetic level. Where Mahajan's style has always been aggressive and solution first, Lad chose a calmer, more collaborative approach, mindful of just how emotionally charged the Maratha movement is.

With his network across Mumbai's social circles, backing from the Chief Minister, and an evident ability to connect with the Maratha community, Prasad Lad has emerged as a key player in defusing this crisis, and is now being seen as the BJP's next go to man for conflict resolution.

"I'm glad that I could fulfil, the responsibility the Chief Minister gave me. Devendraji, as Chief Minister, has done far more for the Maratha community than any of his predecessors. Manoj dada had 15 key demands, and almost all of them have been addressed. The Hyderabad Gazette issue is sub judice, so a quick decision isn't possible there, but the government has taken several alternative steps and decisions to help the Maratha community. There was some communication gap between the government and Manoj dada Jarange, and I'm glad I could help bridge it. I take pride in the fact that Manoj dada broke his fast with water from my hands. We are equally concerned about his health. The fast has ended, now my humble request to him is to also withdraw the agitation," said Prasad Lad, BJP MLC.

Expired saline case: Patient dies in hosp

Family demands action against those responsible

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Allegations have been raised regarding the death of a patient at the Vashi Municipal Corporation Hospital after he was allegedly administered an expired saline drip. Gopiram Khadse (50) had been admitted to the hospital on August 31 after experiencing dizziness. While the saline was being administered, he developed hives and severe itching. Although his relatives informed the nursing staff, it is alleged that timely treatment was not provided. Subsequently, as his condition deteriorated, he was moved to the ICU and later transferred to Fortis Hospital on September 1, where he passed away during treatment.

Following the patient's death, relatives and associates staged a protest at the hospital. The protesters demanded action against the concerned doctor and nursing staff, as well as compensation for the Khadse family. According to the deceased's son, Ajay Khadse, a nurse admitted the error after being shown a photograph of the saline bottle, and treatment for the patient was initiated thereafter. Ajay Khadse claimed that his father's life could have been saved had timely and appropriate medical care been provided.

Meanwhile, Ravindra Mhatre, the Medical Superintendent of Vashi Municipal Corporation Hospital, stated that a committee has already been constituted to investigate the matter. He clarified that a request has been submitted to the headquarters to initiate action in accordance with regulations, and those found guilty will face consequences based on the inquiry report. He also mentioned that the deceased patient was receiving treatment under the municipal corporation's quota.


Gopiram Khadse

Expressing his anguish over the situation, the son, Vijay Khadse, stated, "We have already lodged a complaint regarding this, yet it appears that no action has been taken. I have been trying to contact them repeatedly, but I am receiving no response." They aren't telling me anything; they just say, "We'll see." I have requested them to speak on camera, but they are refusing. My demand is that those responsible face action and be dismissed from their jobs. Furthermore, since I have lost the sole breadwinner of the family, I demand assistance.

Meanwhile, Hospital Superintendent Ravindra Mhatre stated that an inquiry committee has been set up to address the suspicions raised by the patient's relatives, and further action will be taken once the committee's and post-mortem reports are received.

Is Chembur waiting for a disaster?

CONTINUED FROM PAGE 1

Warning came 14 years ago

In 2012, residents under the banner of Chembur Citizens Forum approached the Bombay High Court through their lawyer, Mahesh Menon, and filed a Public Interest Litigation raising concerns over road widening and the condition of the area's road infrastructure.

The residents had pointed to severe constriction of the road corridor connecting Mahul and Ghatkopar, with illegal shops, hawkers and infrastructure work, including Monorail-related activity, cited among the problems affecting vehicular movement.

The litigation did not produce an overnight solution.

Eight years later, the issue was still before the High Court.

In its February 12, 2020 order, the Bombay High Court recorded the BMC's assurance that road-widening work would be completed by December 2020. The Bench was clearly unimpressed by the pace of progress. The Court recorded that its expectation was that the road would be widened to the required width by December 2020, but "that does not seem to be happening."

The Court also examined the revised total-station survey and demarcation exercise around Ashish Talao and questioned how the widening would actually be taken forward.

The message was unmistakable: surveys, rehabilitation issues and other hurdles could not be allowed to become an endless excuse for delaying road widening.

The then Zonal Deputy Municipal Commissioner was directed to file an affidavit explaining the proposed course of action and how the civic administration intended to meet its stated deadline. The matter was listed for March 6, 2020.

The latest publicly verifiable order located in the PIL is from February 2020. Hence, legally, it would be unsafe to claim that the PIL is still pending in 2026 without checking the current High Court case-status record.

The benzene leak provided the kind of emergency that road planners are expected to anticipate. A hazardous tanker could not simply be allowed to remain amid moving traffic. The road had to be secured. Vehicles had to be stopped. Public transport had to be halted. Emergency personnel needed a protected operating zone.

Chembur cannot run on luck

The danger is amplified by the area's industrial character. Petroleum and chemical installations, heavy vehicles, tankers, public transport and residential neighbourhoods all operate within the same road network.

Local concerns over tanker parking have also resurfaced following the incident. The local resident alleged that chemical tankers are routinely parked on roads near residential areas and claimed that around 2,000 chemical tankers are parked in the area. Local corporator Snehal Shivkar has reportedly demanded a dedicated truck terminus.

Those claims must be independently verified. But Monday's incident does not need interpretation. One leak. Two roads stopped. Public transport halted. A 500-metre exclusion zone. More than two hours of emergency intervention.

This time, there were no casualties. That was luck backed by an effective emergency response.

It cannot be the city's safety strategy.

WHERE'S THE BACKUP?

The road had to disappear from the traffic map for the emergency to be contained. That raises an obvious question: where is Chembur's backup?
If Mahul Road and Mysore Colony Road are simultaneously closed during a major accident, can the surrounding roads handle the diverted traffic?
Can ambulances move without delay?
Can fire tenders reach residential areas?
Where is the designated evacuation corridor for a neighbourhood surrounded by chemical and petroleum installations?
And how quickly can thousands of residents be moved if the next incident is bigger than a tanker leak?

THE QUESTION BMC CAN'T AVOID

Fourteen years after residents first went to court over road infrastructure, the civic administration must answer a basic question:
What happened to the road-widening commitments placed before the High Court?
If the required widening was supposed to be completed by December 2020, what work was actually completed?
What remains pending?
What is the present width and carrying capacity of the affected road corridor?
And has BMC prepared a dedicated emergency traffic plan for the industrial belt?
Chembur residents do not need another survey, another deadline or another assurance.
They need roads capable of carrying ordinary traffic — and roads capable of carrying people to safety when ordinary traffic suddenly becomes an extraordinary emergency.
The benzene tanker was moved on Monday night.
The bigger problem remains on the road.

LET YOUR HAIR BREATHE

Clutcher Alert: Your Favourite Hairstyle Accessory Could Be Putting Stress on Your Hair

Hair clutchers, claw clips and other easy-to-use hair accessories have become a daily favourite for many women. They are quick, comfortable and often considered a gentler alternative to tight rubber bands. But dermatologists warn that how you use a hair clutcher matters, especially when the hair is pulled tightly or the accessory is worn for long hours.

The concern is not necessarily the clutcher itself, but the constant tension, pulling and pressure it can put on the hair and scalp.

One condition linked to repeated tension on the hair is traction alopecia. According to the American Academy of Dermatology (AAD), hairstyles that continuously pull on the scalp can cause hair loss. If the tension continues for a long time, the damage can become permanent.

When does a clutcher become a problem?

A loosely placed clutcher that holds the hair without pulling is generally less concerning than a hairstyle that keeps the hair tightly stretched.

Problems can arise when people twist their hair tightly before securing it, use a very tight clip or repeatedly position the clip in the same area. Constant pressure and pulling can contribute to hair breakage and scalp discomfort. Pain or discomfort should not simply be ignored. Dermatologists point out that if a hairstyle hurts, it may be putting excessive tension on the scalp.

It is not just about hair fall

Repeated tension can first show up as tenderness, discomfort, broken strands or thinning around areas that experience the most pulling. Over time, continued tension may contribute to traction alopecia.

The AAD recommends avoiding hairstyles that continuously pull on the hair and suggests switching between hairstyles to reduce repeated stress. Does this mean you should stop using clutchers? Not necessarily.

The key is moderation and avoiding excessive tension. Choose a clip that is appropriate for your hair volume, avoid twisting the hair too tightly and give your scalp regular breaks.

Instead of keeping the same tightly pulled hairstyle throughout the day, let the hair down when possible. Also avoid repeatedly brushing or tugging at the hair, as excessive handling can contribute to breakage.

Watch out for these signs

If you regularly use hair clutchers or other accessories, pay attention to:

- Scalp pain or tenderness
- Hair breakage around the hairline
- Thinning near the temples
- Receding hairline
- Increased hair fall after removing the accessory
- Redness or irritation on the scalp

Time to see a dermatologist

If hair loss continues or becomes noticeable, it is better to consult a dermatologist rather than assuming the accessory is the only cause. Hair loss can have several causes, including genetics, hormonal changes, nutritional deficiencies and scalp conditions. Your hair accessory may look harmless, but repeated pulling is not. A hair clutcher does not automatically mean hair damage; the real issue is excessive tension and prolonged use. So, the next time you put your hair up, remember one simple rule: if your hairstyle hurts, it is too tight. Giving your hair and scalp regular breaks could help prevent unnecessary breakage and tension-related hair loss.



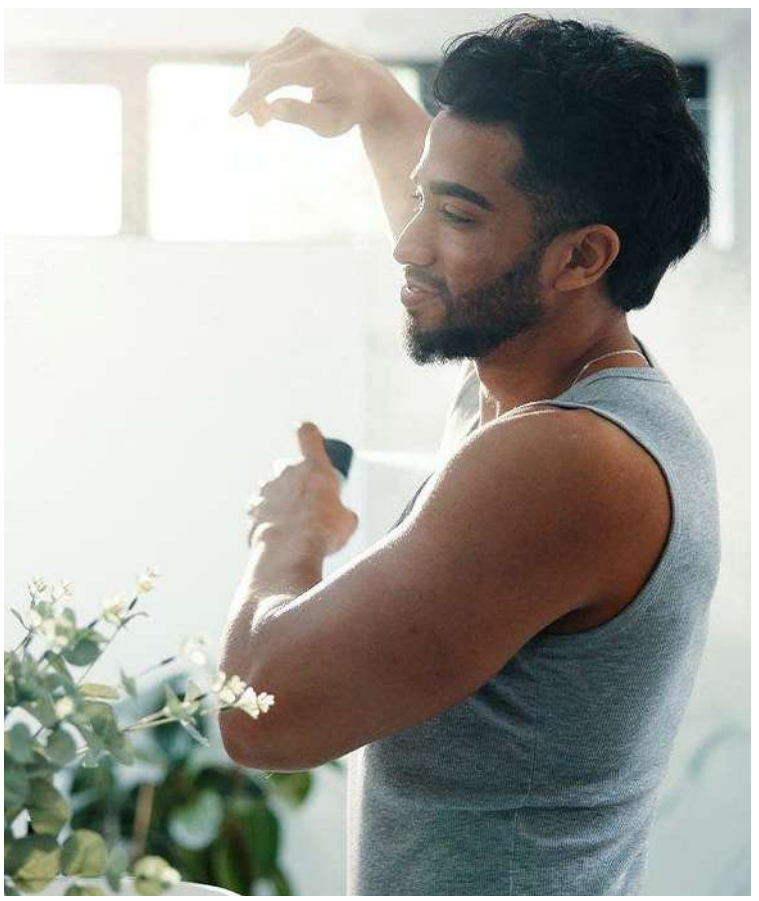
No Shower Before a Date!

Meet the 'Pheromone-Maxxing' Trend Taking Over Dating

You have picked the perfect outfit, checked your hair twice, sprayed your favourite perfume and are ready for a first date. But what if the latest dating trend tells you to do the exact opposite — skip the shower, ditch the deodorant and let your natural body smell do the flirting?

Sounds strange? Welcome to the world of pheromone-maxxing, a social media-driven trend that is encouraging some young men to believe that their natural body scent could make them more attractive to potential partners.

The trend is part of the internet's growing obsession with everything ending in "-maxxing" — essentially the idea of optimising one particular aspect of yourself. In this case, the focus is on supposedly maximising natural chemical signals that could influence attraction.



The idea behind the trend

Pheromones are chemical substances released by animals that can influence the behaviour or responses of other members of the same species. This has led some social media users to wonder whether humans might also have similar chemical signals that influence romantic attraction.

The theory is simple: if your natural scent could attract someone, why wash it away with soap, shampoo, deodorant or perfume before a date?

Some followers of the trend have reportedly taken it further by wearing unwashed clothes and deliberately avoiding deodorant to preserve their "natural musk".

But before you cancel your shower appointment, there is an important scientific catch.

Does your body odour really attract people? Science does not have a clear yes.

Researchers have not conclusively identified a human pheromone that can reliably make another person feel attracted. While studies have suggested that people can respond differently to natural body scents, the evidence remains mixed.

One frequently discussed experiment involved participants smelling T-shirts worn by other people. It suggested that natural body odour may carry information that people subconsciously respond to. However, subsequent research has not established a specific human chemical that works like an attraction switch.

So, having a natural scent is one thing. Believing that skipping your shower will automatically make your date fall for you is quite another.

Natural scent vs. smelling unpleasant

There is also a difference between allowing your natural scent to exist and deliberately avoiding basic hygiene.

Body odour can be influenced by several factors, including genetics, diet and the environment. But that does not mean an unwashed body is secretly producing a romantic superpower.

In fact, what one person considers an attractive natural scent may simply be unpleasant to another.

And that brings us to the biggest problem with the trend: attraction is personal.

The dating rule that still works

Dating trends may change every week, but some rules remain surprisingly simple.

Take a shower. Wear clean clothes. Use deodorant if you normally do. Wear a fragrance if you enjoy it — but don't overdo it.

Most importantly, don't treat social media trends as scientific fact.

The idea of pheromone-maxxing may make for an entertaining conversation starter, but there is currently no solid scientific evidence that skipping a shower will make your date more attracted to you.

After all, there is a difference between **"I like your natural scent" and "I can smell you from across the restaurant."

When it comes to first dates, perhaps the safest formula is still the oldest one:good hygiene, confidence and being yourself.

Jarange Patil ends hunger strike
— Maratha reservation activist Manoj Jarange Patil ended his hunger strike by drinking water offered by BJP MLC Prasad Lad, even as he maintained that he would remain firm on his demands and would call off the agitation only after their implementation begins.

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Friday, September 4, 2026
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'3.5 CR LAKHPATI DIDIS CREATED'

Union Minister Shivraj Chouhan says target is 6 crore across the country

#MUMBAI
@ThePuneMirror

Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Thursday participated in a tree plantation drive alongside 'Lakhpati Didis' in Mumbai and held an interaction with women from Self-Help Groups (SHGs) ahed of his meeting with bankers.

"Today, I planted trees alongside 'Lakhpati Didis' in Mumbai. Our Prime Minister has pledged to create six crore Lakhpati Didis. I am happy to share that approximately 3.5 crore Lakhpati Didis have already been created, and we are now moving rapidly towards achieving the target of six crore," Chouhan said.

The Minister acknowledged that women often face difficulties in obtaining bank loans due to numerous formalities and delays in disbursement. "Before meeting with bankers, a meeting is scheduled for today in Mumbai; we decided to first consult the women themselves: those working in Self-Help Groups and starting various businesses to become Lakhpati Didis. We want to understand the difficulties and challenges they face," he said.

During the interaction, more than 100 Lakhpati Didis joined virtually from Assam, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, and Uttarakhand.

A beneficiary running a CSP centre said she had received an individual loan four times, but other women had not, and some bank branches were refusing to accept more than one application. Responding, Chouhan said, "We will ask the bank why they are taking more than one application."


Shivraj Singh Chouhan with Lakhpati Didis.

A Self Help Group member from Maharashtra flagged that 21.49 per cent of the local population is tribal and they lack digital documents for banking, and that women were being denied loans due to poor CIBIL scores of their husbands. The Minister assured that he would take up the issue with bankers.

A woman entrepreneur from Bijnor said she started soap-making work in 2023 and her business grew rapidly, but her bank refused a loan for expansion and files remained stuck. Another beneficiary from Pune, working as a Bank Sakhi under Umed Abhiyan, said she got Rs 4 lakh from the bank and that some banks were asking for pollution certificates.

Chouhan said, "Our effort is that whatever obstacles are coming in the way of Didis starting their work, we are able to resolve those obstacles properly... We will soon create a helpline."

On the Lakhpati Didi initiative, he said, "The PM's aim under the Lakhpati Didi scheme is to make women strong entrepreneurs. We have to take it from three crore Lakhpati Didis to six crore Didis. Under that, today we have come to meet the Didis to understand their problems and to find a solution for them with the bankers."

The Union Minister told reporters, "They shared that while they have been able to start their own businesses and achieve 'Lakhpati' status thanks to bank loans, they are also facing various challenges. These issues include complex paperwork and formalities required for loans, the need for repeated bank visits, demands for guarantees or collateral, and instances where they receive a loan of only Rs 1.5 lakh despite needing Rs 5 lakh. We are currently heading into a meeting with bankers to address these matters... Our target is for SHGs to receive loans totalling Rs 10 lakh crore and for individual women to receive Rs 1 lakh crore over five years to support their work. Today's meeting with bankers is aimed at fulfilling this objective, following our discussions with the women."

A Lakhpati Didi is a Self-Help Group member who earns an annual household income of Rs 1,00,000 or more. This income is calculated for at least four agricultural seasons or business cycles, with an average monthly income exceeding Rs 10,000, so that it is sustainable. The initiative focuses on diversified livelihood activities for women. **ANI**

Sawant hits out at BJP

'I doubt their devotion towards god'

#MUMBAI
@ThePuneMirror

Shiv Sena (UBT) MP Arvind Sawant recently questioned the appointment of Air Marshal Jitendra Mishra (Retd) as the first CEO of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust.

Reacting to the appointment, Sawant said, "It's okay, but that doesn't mean that whatever you do, the first crime is forgiven. You have committed theft, which is why we have to appoint an air marshal."

Sawant also raised questions over the Trust's devotion towards the god, saying, "I doubt and fear their devotion towards the god."

His comments came after the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Tirth Kshetra Trust on Wednesday appointed retired Air Marshal Jitendra Mishra as its Chief Executive Officer (CEO), besides appointing three new trustees.

The decisions were taken at a meeting of the Trust's trustees in Ayodhya, which also discussed the appointment of the CEO, filling vacant trustee posts, approval of the 2025-26 annual accounts, progress of the SIT probe into alleged financial irregularities and developments before the Supreme Court.

Mishra was appointed on the recommendation of the committee constituted for selection of the CEO. He has 39 years of experience in various branches of the Indian Air Force, extensive leadership experience and has been awarded the Uttam Yudh Seva Medal.



On the Bombay High Court directing the CBI to register an FIR in the Disha Salian death case, Sawant said the agency should proceed in accordance with the court's direction.

"It's okay if the court has advised them. I think in the past, the CBI made an inquiry, and after that, what they found, let them do it," he said. **ANI**

Nashik Kumbh

Hackathon deadline extended

Aimed at developing technology-driven solutions for the gathering

#NASHIK
@ThePuneMirror

The Nashik Trimbakeshwar Kumbh Mela Authority recently extended the deadline for its technology hackathon by 15 days to September 15, following requests from startups and young technology professionals seeking more time to submit solutions for key challenges of the upcoming Simhastha Kumbh Mela.

The hackathon, aimed at developing technology-driven solutions for the mega religious gathering, covers six key areas including sanitation, COVID/first response, 360-degree surveillance and security.

The original deadline was August 31. Around 50 solutions will be shortlisted for presentations, of which 18 will be selected. The top six will subsequently be presented before the Maharashtra Chief Minister at a proposed Tech Summit in Nashik.

Solutions found suitable will be considered for implementation during the Simhastha Kumbh Mela, Mela Authority Commissioner Shekhar Singh said.

Singh urged college students, startups and technology entrepreneurs to participate in the hackathon, calling it an opportunity to have innovative solutions deployed during the Kumbh Mela. Awards and other recognition are also proposed for selected participants.


File photo of Nashik Kumbh Mela

Earlier on Friday, Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis said the Kumbh Bhakti Sangam has begun while expressing confidence that all infrastructure and Kumbh-related works will be completed well before the first 'Parvani'.

He said the flag-hoisting ceremony for the Kumbh Mela in Nashik is scheduled for October 31, following which programmes will be conducted according to the dates already announced. Fadnavis added that the Bhakti Sangam aims to bring together devotional traditions from across the country and represents the spiritual essence of the Kumbh.

"The Kumbh Bhakti Sangam has begun today. Through this Bhakti Sangam, we are showcasing the devotional traditions from across the country. The real significance of the Kumbh is spiritual confluence. Therefore, through this event, we are trying to create a similar confluence of devotion," the Maharashtra CM said.

The Chief Minister acknowledged that people are currently facing inconvenience due to the large number of development works being undertaken simultaneously in Nashik and Trimbakeshwar. He assured residents that the ongoing projects would transform the face of Nashik and Trimbakeshwar once completed.

"All the Kumbh-related works are progressing rapidly. There are some difficulties, and we are working to resolve them. It is also true that people are facing inconvenience because of these works," Fadnavis said on Friday.

The Nashik Kumbh is held every 12 years, with people coming to take a holy dip in the Godavari River. **ANI**



WILL WAR END OR CONTINUE?

Trump weighs declaring it over; Pentagon extends deployment of troops

#WASHINGTON
@ThePuneMirror

Seven months into the Iran war, US President Donald Trump is privately weighing a declaration that the war is over, even while the Pentagon lengthens troop deployments in West Asia, pointing to the possibility that the tensions may continue into next year, according to a Wall Street Journal report.

The report appeared as a new wave of strikes took place between the US and Iran on Tuesday. The United States Central Command (CENTCOM) stated on Wednesday that it had conducted strikes against multiple sites inside Iran.

Tehran replied by hitting US-linked facilities across the Gulf.



Shia Muslims celebrate after the announcement of a two-week ceasefire by the US and Iran, in Srinagar in April ANI Photo

Iran strongly condemned the latest US strikes and accused Washington of violating its sovereignty and targeting non-military infrastructure and civilian sites in several Iranian provinces.

Iran's Ministry of Foreign Affairs said Iranian armed forces had responded with "crushing defensive strikes" against US military bases that it described as the origin, support and staging points for the American attacks.

Iranian officials stated that 18 people died and 142 others were wounded in the most recent US strikes.

According to the WSJ, Trump has spoken with senior aides about "whether to declare the Iran war over," a course he privately backs, especially with mid-term elections nearing and energy prices climbing because of the war.

The president takes the position that Iran will in time dismantle its nuclear programme under severe economic strain. The development followed the US start last week of Operation Economic Outcast, designed to hit Tehran's principal economic supports such as oil, shipping, aviation and digital assets.

Even as Trump presses for an end to the Iran war, US Secretary of War Pete Hegseth is quietly lengthening troop deployment in West Asia, "in a sign that the conflict could drag well into next year", the Wall Street Journal reported.

The decision is meant to leave the president with "options in the war", the outlet reported, citing sources familiar with the matter.

As the latest exchanges unfolded between the US and Iran, Washington guided 40 commercial ships through the key waterway on Tuesday, two US officials told CNN.

The figure for vessels protected in one operation stood as the highest so far in the ongoing war, they said.

US forces also hit nearly 60 Iranian military sites around the Strait of Hormuz. Targets covered air defence installations, radar systems, maritime infrastructure, mine-laying facilities and communications networks. **AGENCIES**

Rubio issues veiled warning

#WASHINGTON
@ThePuneMirror

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio has said that he does not believe there are talks currently going on for a trade deal between India and Iran, while warning that countries helping Tehran amid the West Asia conflict to evade US sanctions could face sanctions themselves.

Rubio's remarks came after Prime Minister Narendra Modi met Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian on the sidelines of the 26th Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, where the two leaders discussed bilateral ties, trade and the prevailing situation in West Asia.

Speaking to Brian Kilmeade on The Brian Kilmeade Show on Tuesday when asked about the meeting and whether India and Iran were setting up some form of trade deal, Rubio said, "Well, I don't think there's a trade deal between India and Iran."

The State Secretary further stated that countries develop their own foreign policies and noted that several countries maintain contact with the Iranian regime.

"Obviously, there are – countries all develop their own foreign policy, and many countries around the world talk to the Iranian regime," Rubio said.

The US Secretary of State, however, stressed the US position that countries should not assist Iran in circumventing sanctions. "I think what ultimately happens, though, is – and the President's been very clear – is no country should be helping Iran evade sanctions," Rubio. **AGENCIES**

Iran blacklists 11 vessels

More will be added for 'non-compliance': Hormuz control panel

#TEHRAN
@ThePuneMirror

Iran's Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA) on Wednesday (local time) blacklisted a further 11 vessels transiting through the Strait of Hormuz over what it described as 'non-compliance' with Iranian protocols, taking the total number of vessels barred from the strategically important waterway to 56.

In a post on X, the PGSA said its Non-Compliant Vessels (NCV) list had been updated, while acknowledging information submitted by members of the public that contributed to the latest entries.

"The NCV list has been updated on the website. Certain entries on this list have been established through information voluntarily submitted by the public, and the PGSA wishes to formally acknowledge and thank those who have contributed to this effort," the authority said.

The PGSA, a regulatory body established by Iran to manage and monitor maritime operations through the strategic waterway, has warned that any vessel cooperating with a blacklisted ship could also be added to the list.

PGSA on its website stated vessels found violating Iranian protocols for the Strait of Hormuz could face restrictions on future passages, including fines, detention or confiscation.

The authority has also advised cargo owners shipping to and from the Persian Gulf to review the NCV list before chartering vessels to avoid potential issues.

"Any vessel cooperating with listed vessels (via STS, transhipment, etc.) will be added to the list," the PGSA said.



'RENAME IT TRUMP STRAIT?'

US President Donald Trump raised the prospect of renaming the Strait of Hormuz to the "Trump Strait", questioning the designation of the critical waterway in a social media release. In a statement published on his social media platform, Trump remarked, "Now that we have it under U.S.A. control, should we change the name Hormuz Strait to TRUMP STRAIT???" Asserting that the suggested title would be deemed "hotter" than previously, the post concluded with the signature "President DONALD J. TRUMP", alongside expressions of gratitude towards readers for their attention to his proposal.

The authority has stated that vessels seeking removal from the blacklist must submit a formal application with supporting justifications.

The latest action comes a week after Tehran blacklisted 45 tankers that it claimed had violated its rules for navigating the Strait of Hormuz.

On May 18, Iran's Supreme National Security Council formally launched the PGSA as a dedicated mechanism for governing maritime traffic through the Strait of Hormuz.

The council reported a statement announcing that the official X account of the Persian Gulf Strait Authority had become operational.

"In the Name of God. The official X account of the Persian Gulf Strait Authority (#PGSA) is now live. Follow us for real-time updates on the Hormuz Strait operations and latest developments," the authority said in the statement.

The establishment of the PGSA marked the formal introduction of a dedicated Iranian body to oversee maritime traffic and operations linked to the Strait of Hormuz, a strategically important waterway for global oil and energy shipments. **AGENCIES**

Saudi slams tanker attack

#RIYADH
@ThePuneMirror

Saudi Arabia on Wednesday claimed that Iran targeted an oil tanker, Sidr, as it transited through the Strait of Hormuz, resulting in fatalities among the vessel's crew.

In an official statement, Saudi Arabia's Ministry of Foreign Affairs expressed stern condemnation of the action. Riyadh extended its condemnation to broader regional military action, citing Iranian attacks directed at Jordan, Bahrain, and Kuwait.

"The Ministry of Foreign Affairs expresses the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia's condemnation of the Islamic Republic of Iran's targeting of the Saudi tanker (Sidr) while it was transiting the Strait of Hormuz, and resulted in fatalities among the tanker's crew," the Ministry stated.

Saudi Arabia reaffirmed its full solidarity with these neighbouring nations and expressed unwavering support for any measures they take to safeguard their sovereignty and national security against external threats.

Highlighting the risks posed to global stability, the ministry underscored the urgent need to protect maritime trade routes and ensure the security of global energy supplies. The Kingdom emphasised adherence to the principles of international law, the UN Charter, state sovereignty, and good-neighbourly relations.

"The Kingdom stresses the need to halt escalation and respect the security and safety of international navigation," the statement read. **AGENCIES**

HEALTH TIP: The best foods for an upset stomach are bland, low-fat items that digest easily and help settle your digestive tract.



Bananas are easy to digest, and rich in potassium to replace lost electrolytes. White rice and toast or crackers are also recommended for people with an upset stomach.

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ASK THE SEXPERT



DR ROHAN JAHAGIRDAR
Psychiatrist & Sexpert

1 I am a 21-years-old female. I'm very used to wearing tampons. I think my hymen is broken. Does that mean I have lost my virginity with a tampon?
Dear Ma'am, tampons can cause the hymen to stretch or tear but that does not affect the virginity. Only having sex can affect your virginity status. Do see a doctor and get yourself checked for injury or local infection.

2 I am a 25-year-old female. I've been trying to get pregnant for the last 6 months but have failed. Is the process automatic wherein the sperm knows where to go into my fallopian tube or is it missing some direction?
Dear Ma'am, I think you're missing some information on how one gets pregnant! If you have been trying for 6 months do check with your doctor if you or your husband have some issues with fertility. The sperms will follow their natural biological journey and I don't think they will need GOOGLE MAPS for their direction! (pun intended) I hope you reach your destination!

3 I am a 22-year-old female.I have UTI and was prescribed some medicine for it. I'm scared to take it. Can I just have cranberry juice instead to cure my UTI?Please help.
Dear Ma'am, it can definitely help you with the summer heat! But you will need to take the medicine if you want to get better as having cranberry juice is not a treatment for UTI and it is unlikely to cure it.

4 I am a 19-year-old male. I masterbate everyday. I have been having hair loss recently. Will continuing my activity of masterbation cause more hair loss for me?
Dear Sir, unless you are pulling your own hair out that is unlikely to happen. (pun intended) as there is no scientific evidence that hair loss is caused due to masterbation. Do visit a doctor for your hair loss problem. Don't worry.

SEND YOUR QUERIES RELATED TO SEXUAL PROBLEMS TO
sexpert@punemirror.com

YOU'RE THE FIRST GURU IN YOUR CHILD'S LIFE

ASK THE EXPERT PAEDIATRICIAN



Dr Sambhaji Mahadik, MBBS MD (Paediatrics), Consultant Paediatrician, Umarji Mother & Child Care Hospital

What are developmental milestones, and why are they important?
Developmental milestones are key skills and behaviors children typically achieve as they grow, such as sitting, walking, talking, and social interaction. These milestones help parents and professionals understand whether a child is developing on track. While each child develops at their own pace, milestones offer a general framework to identify strengths and potential areas needing support. They are important because early detection of delays can lead to timely interventions, which greatly improve long-term outcomes.

What role do parents play in supporting early physical development?
Parents are a child's first and most influential teachers. By providing a safe and stimulating environment, they encourage activities that build motor skills—such as tummy time for infants, playtime with soft toys, crawling, and outdoor activities as children grow. Parents who actively participate in play help strengthen their child's muscles, coordination, and confidence. Even simple interactions like guiding a baby's hand to reach for objects or encouraging a toddler to climb small steps can greatly support physical development.

How can parents promote language development in young children?
Language development thrives on daily interaction. Parents can support it through talking, reading, storytelling, and singing. Naming objects around the home, engaging in two-way conversations—even with infants—and responding to babbling encourage communication skills. Reading aloud daily helps children learn new words, sentence structures, and concepts. Parents who listen patiently and expand on a child's speech ("Yes, that's a dog! It's a big brown dog!") help enrich vocabulary and comprehension.

What is the role of parents in supporting cognitive development?
Parents nurture cognitive skills by offering opportunities for exploration and problem-solving. Age-appropriate toys, puzzles, sorting games, and creative play help stimulate thinking. Asking open-ended questions like "What do you think will happen next?" encourages curiosity and reasoning. Daily routines—such as cooking, grocery shopping, or even cleaning—can also become learning moments when parents involve children in counting, identifying shapes, or describing actions.

UMARJI Mother & Child Care

How can parents support emotional and social development?
Emotional security is fundamental to healthy development. When parents respond consistently and lovingly to their child's needs, the child learns trust and emotional regulation. Encouraging children to express feelings, modeling positive social behavior, and guiding them through conflicts helps build empathy and communication skills. Playdates, cooperative games, and family interactions further strengthen social competence.

What can parents do if they notice delays or have concerns?
If parents observe that their child is missing major milestones, it's important not to panic—but equally important not to ignore concerns. They should consult a pediatrician, early childhood specialist, or therapist for guidance. Early assessment and support can make a significant difference. Parents who stay informed, observant, and proactive provide the best foundation for their child's healthy development.

The views/suggestions/opinions/data in the article are the sole responsibility of the expert/organisation.
For queries, please write to **asktheexpert@punemirror.com**

LEND AN EAR, IT'S IMPORTANT...

Study finds a unique sound which alleviates motion sickness



A research group has discovered that using a device that stimulates the inner ear with a specific wavelength of sound reduces motion sickness.

Even a single minute of stimulation with a unique sound, called 'sound spice,' reduced the staggering and discomfort felt by people that were asked to read a document in a moving vehicle. Their findings suggest a simple and effective way to alleviate this common disorder.

A research group led by Takumi Kagawa and Masashi Kato at Nagoya University Graduate School of Medicine.

"Our study demonstrated that short-term stimulation using a unique sound called 'sound spice' alleviates symptoms of motion sickness, such as nausea and dizziness," Kagawa said.

"The effective sound level falls within the range of everyday environmental noise exposure, suggesting that the sound technology is both effective and safe," added Kagawa.

This discovery is an important expansion of recent findings about sound and its effect on the inner ear.

Increasing evidence has suggested that stimulating the part of the inner ear associated with balance using a unique sound can potentially improve balance. Using a mouse model and humans, the researchers identified a unique sound at 100 Hz as the optimal frequency.

"Vibrations at the unique sound stimulate the otolithic organs in the inner ear, which detect linear acceleration and gravity," Kato explained.

"This suggests that a unique sound stimulation can broadly activate the vestibular system, which is responsible for maintaining balance and spatial orientation," added Kato.

To test the effectiveness of the devices, they recruited voluntary participants who were exposed to the unique sound. Following the stimulation, motion sickness was induced by a swing, a driving simulator, or riding in a car.

The researchers used postural control, ECG readings, and Motion Sickness Assessment Questionnaire results to assess the stimulation's effectiveness.

The researchers found symptoms such as "lightheadedness" and "nausea," which are often seen with motion sickness, were alleviated.

"These results suggest that activation of sympathetic nerves, which are often dysregulated in motion sickness, was objectively improved by the unique sound exposure," Kato said.

"The health risk of short-term exposure to our unique sound is minimal," Kagawa said.

"Given that the stimulus level is well below workplace noise safety standards, this stimulation is expected to be safe when used properly."

Their results suggest a safe and effective way to improve motion sickness, potentially offering help to millions of sufferers. The researchers plan to further develop the technology with the aim of practical application for a variety of travel situations including air and sea travel.

IMMEDIATE RELIEF
- **Look ahead:** Stare at a fixed point in the distance or the horizon
- **Close your eyes:** Lean your seat back and rest with your eyes shut
- **Get fresh air:** Roll down the car window or turn on the air conditioner vents toward your face
- **Stop screens:** Put away phones, tablets, and books immediately
- **Sip or chew:** Try ginger ale, peppermint gum, or ginger candy

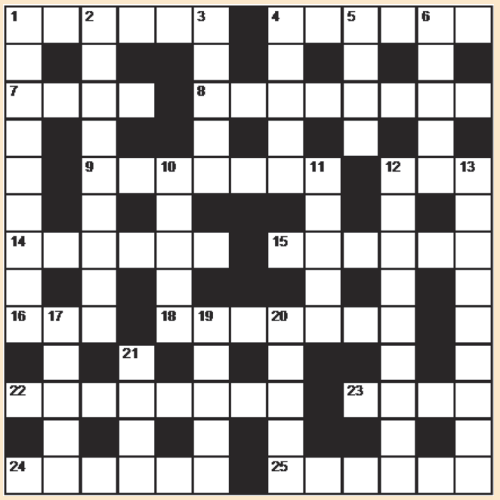
PREVENTION TIPS
- **Sit in front:** Move to the front passenger seat and face forward.
- **Eat light:** Have a small, bland snack like crackers before you travel instead of a heavy meal.
- **Take medication:** Use over-the-counter options like Dramamine or Bonine about an hour before your trip.
- **Stay still:** Rest your head against the headrest to limit movement

WHAT IS IT?
Motion sickness is a common condition that happens when you're in motion, like riding in a vehicle, while sitting still. It happens when your eyes, inner ear and body send conflicting messages to your brain. Symptoms include nausea, breaking out in cold sweat or headache. Fortunately, there are ways to prevent motion sickness or ease its symptoms.

Chai-Time

Kidzone, Pune Mirror, email us at mirrorfeatures@gmail.com

QUICK 6683



ACROSS
1 Fatal, doomed to die (6)
4 Natural well (6)
7 Long fish (4)
8 Retaliates against or punishes? (4,4)
9 Common, general or universal (7)
12 Second month in short (3)
14 Tempestuous (6)
15 Endorse (6)
16 Internet addresses (3)
18 Cavalryman, rough fierce fellow (7)
22 Major south Indian river (8)
23 Age-old town on the river Indrayani which was the birth place of Sant Tukaram (4)
24 Lebanon's capital (6)
25 Creamy dish (6)

DOWN
1 Ms. Sheshadri of Bollywood (9)
2 Devout or sacred (9)
3 Fall, decline or slip (5)
4 Digital pens (5)
5 Steals from (4)
6 Nook or recess (5)
10 Wanderer (5)
11 Belief system (5)
12 Struggles awkwardly (9)
13 Of ___ ____ : notorious or ill-famed? (3,6)
17 Set in position (5)
19 Strongly criticize (5)
20 Famous writer of fairy stories (5)
21 Duo (4)

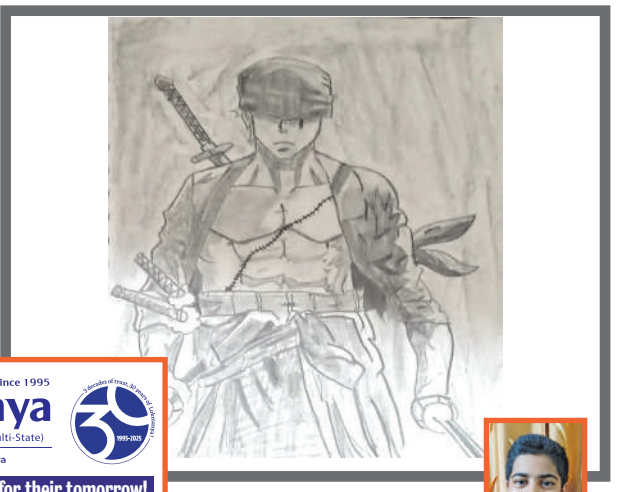
FOR ANSWER SCAN ↓

Please send copies of your children's artworks along with a photo of the artist in A4 size.
Do mention their age and the name of the school they attend. You can also mail us unpublished poems by children.





Vihaan Padole, 10 years,
The Orbis School, Keshav Nagar





Advait Jyoti, 11 years,
MIT VGS, Kothrud, Pune

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Priyadarshani School, Moshi





Hassaan Basha, 10 years,
Lexicon International School, Kalyani Nagar

WHAT YOUR STARS SAY TODAY



Aries — March 21 - April 20

You'll receive surprising support that will grow into real strength later. Connections are favored. If you can hold back your impatience, you'll come out ahead. Your rising optimism will give you an energy boost.



Taurus — April 21 - May 20

It's a great day to introduce changes that will improve your family life—especially in your romantic relationships. Your top priority is to strengthen your most important connections.



Gemini — May 21 - June 21

Opportunity is here for you to express yourself in harmony and to heal old wounds within the family or at work. If your mood doesn't take over, you'll come across as wonderfully idealistic. Keep a cool head and stay in control of your emotions.



Cancer — June 22 - July 23

You'll realize you made the right choice by staying patient. Success is now within reach. It's time to shake up your routine and bring back that easy, effortless feeling. A genuine break focused on your well-being would do you wonders.



Leo — July 24 – August 23

You'll feel like treating yourself—and honestly, it's exactly what you need to recharge today. Your great mood is contagious, and you're lifting the people around you.



Virgo — August 24 - September 23

Today, you'll have the gift of being in the right place at the right time—socially speaking. Positive encounters are strongly favored and can quickly turn into real friendship or a long-term collaboration.



Libra — September 24 - October 22

Big discoveries are on the horizon within your circle today. Stay understanding, and take a step back before you react... You're showing more pragmatism than usual. You also feel the urge to slow down. That way, you'll be even more effective.



Scorpio — October 23 - November 22

Your mood is better than ever, and it's helping you absorb new knowledge. Don't stay shut away—get out and live a little. You feel strong thanks to your positive mindset, but your body needs to unwind too.



Sagittarius — November 23 - December 22

Your practical instincts are sharper than ever today. You'll move mountains if you need to. And you'll feel even better when you take the time to balance and refresh your meals over the long run.



Capricorn — December 23 - January 20

Your drive, fueled by deep optimism, makes you bold. Today, nothing can stand in your way. Your moral compass is strong, and you're in great shape to embrace positive changes to the way you live.



Aquarius — January 21 - February 19

You may feel disappointed if you give in to the urge to help people who don't want it. You'll be calmer and more active at the same time. Everything is fine—just take a little time to refine your ideas in peace.

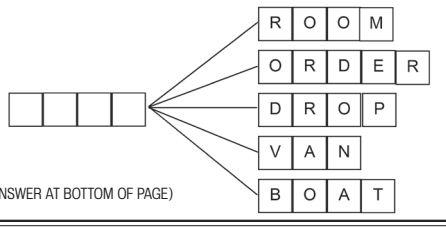


Pisces — February 20 - March 20

Your confidence in yourself will grow. Now is the perfect moment to set the record straight with someone in your circle. Your moral strength is returning. You'll also feel a surge of energizing, optimistic ideas. Still, your body is asking for more rest and care.

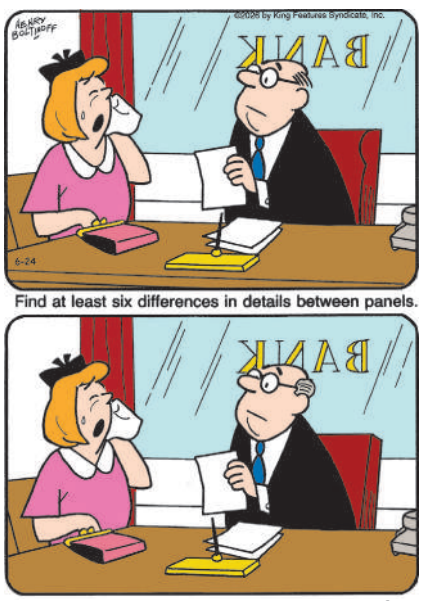
DOUBLE - BARRELLED

What word can be placed in front of the five words shown to form in each case another word ?



(ANSWER AT BOTTOM OF PAGE)

HOCUSFOCUS



Find at least six differences in details between panels.

Differences: 1. Back of chair is different. 2. Purse is moved. 3. Collar is different. 4. Man's hair is different. 5. Top of desk is larger. 6. Pen is moved.

ANSWER FOR DOUBLE-BARRELLED : Mail

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'MAIN TOH NAHI JAUNGI'

Mallika Sherawat Clears the Air on Bigg Boss 20 Entry

With the premiere of Bigg Boss 20 just around the corner, speculation over the celebrity lineup is growing by the day. One name that recently grabbed attention was Bollywood actor Mallika Sherawat. However, the actor has now put the rumours to rest, making it clear that she has no plans to enter Salman Khan's reality show.

Mallika was recently spotted in Mumbai with YouTuber and Bigg Boss OTT 2 winner Abhishek Malhan. During the interaction, paparazzi asked her directly whether she would be entering Bigg Boss 20. The actor gave a straightforward answer — "Nahi," later adding, "Main toh nahi jaungi," clearly ruling out her participation.

The clarification comes at a time when the upcoming season has been surrounded by several casting rumours. With Salman Khan returning as host, fans have been eagerly waiting to know which celebrities will step inside the controversial reality show. *Bigg Boss 20* is scheduled to premiere on September 6, adding to the buzz around the yet-to-be-revealed lineup.

Mallika's latest statement is also in line with her earlier comments about the show. In August, the actor had spoken about why the Bigg Boss format has never appealed to her. She explained that being confined inside a house while being constantly filmed is not the kind of reality television she enjoys. Instead, she has expressed greater interest in shows involving travel, adventure, food and conversations.

Interestingly, this is not the first time Mallika has been linked to Bigg Boss. Similar reports surfaced last year ahead of Bigg Boss 19, but she had then also denied plans to participate. Her latest response once again makes her position clear.

While Mallika will not be entering the Bigg Boss 20 house, reality television is not entirely off her list. She is currently appearing in Karan Johar-hosted The Traitors Season 2, where she has emerged as one of the contestants attracting attention. The finale of the show is scheduled for September 3.

Meanwhile, Bigg Boss 20 continues to generate curiosity with several celebrity names being linked to the season. However, many of these names remain part of speculation until officially confirmed by the makers.

For Mallika, the message is simple: despite the rumours and fan expectations, she is not walking into Salman Khan's Bigg Boss 20 house.

Orry Reveals His Secret



Orry, who is currently making headlines with his unexpected stint on Khatron Ke Khiladi 15, has revealed that he took up the challenging reality show without even informing his parents. Known for his glamorous social media presence and celebrity connections, Orry has surprised viewers by taking on several difficult stunts on the Rohit Shetty-hosted show.

Orry recently shared a video on Instagram featuring moments from his journey on the stunt-based reality show. Along with the video, he penned a note reflecting on his experience and explained that he deliberately chose to go through the journey without depending on anyone back home.

According to Orry, he travelled for the show "completely alone" and did not even tell his parents that he was participating. He said there were no regular calls, updates or discussions about the stunts he was performing. For him, the experience was about discovering what he could do when he had no audience, advice or familiar support system around him.

The social media personality also admitted that he initially considered surviving five episodes an achievement. As the competition progressed, he made it through seven episodes and then 10. Reaching the halfway point of the season left him surprised at his own progress.

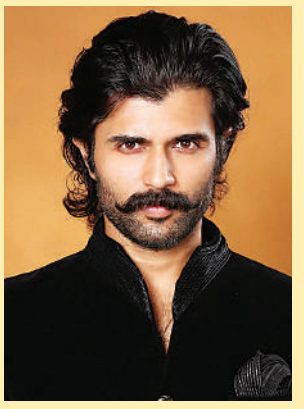
Orry's journey is particularly interesting because his public image is often associated with fashion, parties and Bollywood celebrity circles rather than physically demanding reality television. However, his appearance on Khatron Ke Khiladi 15 has shown viewers a different side of his personality.

In his note, Orry addressed the perception that he is delicate or unable to handle difficult situations. He said the show became a personal test for him, allowing him to prove to himself that he was not the "fragile Barbie doll" people sometimes make him out to be.

Orry did not claim to be a winner when reflecting on his performance. Instead, he acknowledged that he had lost several stunts but maintained that he approached each challenge with confidence.



Vijay Deverakonda Cheers for Rashmika's 'Mysaa'



Rashmika Mandanna is all set to enter a new action-packed phase with her upcoming film Mysaa, and husband Vijay Deverakonda is already cheering her on. The actor recently shared his first reaction to the film's newly unveiled look and release announcement, praising Rashmika's performance and expressing confidence that she will win over her fans once again.

The makers of Mysaa recently released a striking poster featuring Rashmika in a fierce and intense avatar. Unlike the glamorous roles audiences have often seen her play, the actor appears to be stepping into a much more physically demanding and action-oriented character. The poster has already created curiosity among fans who are eager to see her in this new avatar.

Vijay took to social media to share the poster and encouraged Rashmika ahead of the film's release. Calling her "Violent Pilla", he wished her well and said that she would make her fans proud with the project. His affectionate message quickly caught the attention of fans, who were delighted to see the actor openly supporting his wife's latest work.

Mysaa is expected to showcase Rashmika in one of the more challenging roles of her career. The film is being positioned as an action thriller, with its story set against a distinctive tribal backdrop. The makers have also teased high-intensity sequences, including an underwater action sequence, suggesting that the film will be considerably different from Rashmika's previous outings.

The road to Mysaa has not been completely smooth for the actor. Rashmika recently suffered an injury while working on the film. She later revealed that a tendon in her hip area had snapped, forcing her to take several weeks away from work to recover. Despite the setback, she has continued to remain connected with her upcoming projects and is gradually returning to her professional commitments.

Vijay's support comes at an interesting point in Rashmika's career. The actor has previously spoken about how much she values his honest opinions and considers him one of her biggest supporters. Their professional equation has also been closely followed by fans, especially as the two are set to reunite on screen in Ranabaali.

For Rashmika, Mysaa could mark another opportunity to experiment with a different side of her acting abilities. After making a strong impact in films across Telugu, Kannada and Hindi cinema, the actor is now taking on a character that appears to demand more intensity, physicality and emotional strength.

The film is scheduled to arrive worldwide on November 27, 2026.